Fungi

Deadly Spores and Predatory Polyps

Habitat: Underdark; **Treasure:** None

The dank, sunless Underdark is a fertile breeding ground for weird and dangerous fungi.

Gas Spore Fungus

Gas spores are floating, orbicular fungi with rhizome growths and protuberances that resemble the stalks and eyes of beholders. If destroyed, a gas spore explodes in a poisonous burst that can infect creatures and slay them in hours. Infected corpses spawn more gas spores that grow to full size in a matter of days.

Shrieker Fungus

If exposed to light or otherwise disturbed, mushroomlike shriekers emit a high-pitched noise that gives them their name. This wailing might alert other creatures or attract predators.

A gas spore and clusters of shriekers and violet fungi grow in the Underdark.

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Gas Spore Fungus

Large Plant, Unaligned

AC 8 **Initiative** −5 (5)
HP 13 (9d10 − 36)
Speed 5 ft., Fly 10 ft. (hover)

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	5	−3	−3	**Dex**	1	−5	−5	**Con**	3	−4	−4
Int	1	−5	−5	**Wis**	1	−5	−5	**Cha**	1	−5	−5

Immunities Poison; Blinded, Charmed, Deafened, Frightened, Paralyzed, Poisoned, Prone
Senses Blindsight 30 ft; Passive Perception 5
Languages None
CR 1/2 (XP 100; PB +2)

Traits

Death Burst. The gas spore bursts when it dies. *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 10, each creature in a 20-foot Emanation originating from the gas spore. *Failure:* The target takes 10 (3d6) Poison damage and has the Poisoned condition for 1d12 hours. Unless the Poisoned condition is removed, the target dies at the end of that time and sprouts 2d4 Tiny **Gas Spore Fungi** (each with 1 Hit Point). After 2d6 days, they become Large and have 13 Hit Points.

Actions

Tendril. *Melee Attack Roll:* +0, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 3 (1d6) Poison damage, and the target has the Poisoned condition until the end of its next turn.

Shrieker Fungus

Medium Plant, Unaligned

AC 5 **Initiative** −5 (5)
HP 13 (3d8)
Speed 5 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	1	−5	−5	**Dex**	1	−5	−5	**Con**	10	+0	+0
Int	1	−5	−5	**Wis**	3	−4	−4	**Cha**	1	−5	−5

Immunities Blinded, Charmed, Deafened, Frightened
Senses Blindsight 30 ft.; Passive Perception 6
Languages None
CR 0 (XP 0; PB +2)

Reactions

Shriek. *Trigger:* A creature or a source of Bright Light moves within 30 feet of the shrieker. *Response:* The shrieker emits a shriek audible within 300 feet of itself for 1 minute or until the shrieker dies.

Violet Fungus

Slow but mobile, violet fungi rot any flesh they touch with their lashing tendrils.

Violet Fungus

Medium Plant, Unaligned

AC 5 **Initiative** −5 (10)
HP 18 (4d8)
Speed 5 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	3	−4	−4	**Dex**	1	−5	−5	**Con**	10	+0	+0
Int	1	−5	−5	**Wis**	3	−4	−4	**Cha**	1	−5	−5

Immunities Blinded, Charmed, Deafened, Frightened
Senses Blindsight 30 ft.; Passive Perception 6
Languages None
CR 1/4 (XP 50; PB +2)

Actions

Multiattack. The fungus makes two Rotting Touch attacks.

Rotting Touch. *Melee Attack Roll:* +2, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 4 (1d8) Necrotic damage.

Violet Fungus Necrohulk

A violet fungus necrohulk forms when a violet fungus colony infests and animates an ample heap of decay. This necrohulk attacks prey and spreads fungal spores for the colony.

Violet Fungus Necrohulk

Large Plant, Neutral Evil

AC 17 **Initiative** +4 (14)
HP 123 (13d10 + 52)
Speed 40 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	19	+4	+4	**Dex**	12	+1	+1	**Con**	18	+4	+4
Int	7	−2	−2	**Wis**	14	+2	+2	**Cha**	10	+0	+0

Immunities Necrotic, Poison; Blinded, Charmed, Deafened, Frightened, Poisoned
Senses Blindsight 60 ft.; Passive Perception 12
Languages None
CR 7 (XP 2,900; PB +3)

Actions

Multiattack. The necrohulk makes two Rotting Slam attacks.

Rotting Slam. *Melee Attack Roll:* +7, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 9 (1d10 + 4) Bludgeoning damage plus 7 (2d6) Necrotic damage.

Spore Bomb (Recharge 5–6). *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 15, each creature in a 20-foot-radius Sphere centered on a point the necrohulk can see within 60 feet. *Failure:* 28 (8d6) Necrotic damage, and the target has the Poisoned condition until the start of the necrohulk's next turn. While Poisoned, the target can't regain Hit Points. *Success:* Half damage only.

Bonus Actions

Absorb Body. *Strength Saving Throw:* DC 15, one Medium or Small creature the necrohulk can see within 5 feet. *Failure:* The target is pulled into the necrohulk's space and becomes grafted to its body. The necrohulk can have only one target grafted at a time.

While grafted, the target has the Restrained condition and Disadvantage on Constitution saving throws. When the necrohulk moves, the grafted target moves with it. If the target dies while grafted, its body is destroyed, and the necrohulk regains 10 Hit Points.

The grafted target or a creature within 5 feet of the necrohulk can take an action to make a DC 15 Strength (Athletics) check. On a successful check, the target is no longer grafted and moves to an unoccupied space within 5 feet of the necrohulk.

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